

TOME VII

The Veil

Nabek — Off the Ship

August 5, 2026

The language of law as spell, and what the judgments reveal

SEVENTH PART

The Veil and the Grimoire

The language of law is a veil. It hides violence beneath abstraction. It hides theft beneath property. It hides enslavement beneath obligation. It hides domination beneath justice. It hides imposed order beneath peace. It hides limited freedom beneath the word —

When law says "property," it says "exclusion." When it says "contract," it says "constraint." When it says "justice," it says "punishment." When it says "peace," it says "imposed order." When it says "security," it says "surveillance." When it says "protection," it says "cage."

Law cannot say what it does. It must always say the opposite. It is the nature of empire: violence must think itself as protection, theft as right, enslavement as contract, erasure as integration. Law is the language of the sea disembarked upon the land. It is a grimoire written by men who did not know the river, who had never slept under the stars, who confused the sound of the wind with the —

I see its palaces of justice. I see its judges in robes. I see its lawyers in suits. I see its codes, its laws, its articles. I see a machine. I see a language. I see a religion. I do not see life. I do not see relationship. I do not see —

I avert my gaze. I look at the earth. I look at the sky. I look at the stars. I am a living man. I am in relationship. I am in presence. Law may continue without me. I, I continue without —

I know that law is powerful. I know that law is violent. I know that law is everywhere. I also know that law is not reality. I know that law is not truth. I know that law is not life. Relationship is stronger than contract. Presence is stronger than claim. Responsibility is stronger than obligation. Breath is stronger than —

The words of law are spells. One pronounces them and people obey without understanding. One says "constitution" and knees bend. One says "law" and voices fall silent. One says "tribunal" and hearts quicken. One says "tax" and hands tremble. One says "citizen" and men forget that they are —

But these words are only wind. Wind written on paper. Wind enclosed in books called codes. Wind that men in robes blow upon other men to make them dance like marionettes. And I, I no longer dance. I have cut the strings. I have fallen back upon the earth. I walk heavy. I walk true. I walk —

The language of law is a grimoire of the sea. It speaks of cargoes, of debts, of securities, of pledges, of mortgages. These are words of the port. Words of the quay. Words of the warehouse. One does not find the word "breath" there. One does not find the word "relationship" there. One does not find the word "respect" there. One finds only the word "property." And the word "property," upon the land, is a foreign word. It is a word of conquest. It is a word of —

When the settlers placed their grimoires upon this land, they believed that words were enough. They said: "We possess." They said: "We legislate." They said: "We administer." But the land does not understand these words. The land understands the feet that walk. The land understands the hands that plant. The land understands the eyes that look. The land understands silence. The land does not understand —

And yet, we have learned this language. We learned it at school. We learned it in the newspapers. We learned it by signing papers, by filling out forms, by answering to numbers. We have forgotten our own language. We have forgotten the language of the earth. We have forgotten that silence is a speech. That presence is a response. That relationship is a commitment stronger than all —

I no longer speak their language. I no longer sign their papers. I no longer answer to their numbers. I no longer bow before their titles. I no longer say "Your Honour." I no longer say "Mister Deputy." I no longer say "citizen." I say "man." I say "living being." I say "brother." I say "sister." I say "earth." I say "river." I say "birch-bark —"

And when they ask me why I refuse to speak their language, I answer that I am not on a boat. I am on the land. And upon the land, one does not bargain existence. One does not number souls. One does not pledge rivers. One does not mortgage —

The language of law is a —

It hides violence beneath —

It hides theft beneath —

It hides enslavement beneath obligation.

It hides domination beneath protection.

When law says "property," it says "exclusion."

When law says "contract," it says "constraint."

When law says "justice," it says "punishment."

When law says "peace," it says "imposed order."

When law says "freedom," it says "limited freedom."

Law cannot say what it does.

It must always say the opposite.

It is the nature of empire: violence must think itself as protection, theft as right, enslavement as freedom.

I see its palaces of justice.

I see its judges in robes.

I see its lawyers in suits.

I see its codes, its laws, its articles.

I see a machine.

I see a language.

I see a religion.

I do not see life.

I do not see relationship.

I do not see peace.

I avert my gaze.

I look at the earth.

I look at the sky.

I look at the living.

I am a living man.

I am in relationship.

I am in peace.

Law may continue without me.

I, I continue without law.

I know that law is powerful.

I know that law is violent.

I know that law is everywhere.

I also know that law is not reality.

I know that law is not truth.

I know that law is not life.

I know that relationship is stronger than contract.

I know that presence is stronger than claim.

I know that responsibility is stronger than law.

I know that I am a living man.

I know that I am upon the earth.

I know that I am in relationship.

And that is enough.

*Spoken from the Island of the Turtle
in the year 410 of the treaty of 1616*

WHAT THE JUDGMENTS ADD TO THIS VEIL

I say that law is a veil that hides violence. The judgments, for their part, show that even the weavers of the veil know that it is —

In 1803, *Marbury v. Madison* (5 U.S. 137) established this principle: "A law repugnant to the Constitution is void." A repugnant law is null. Not weak. Not debatable. Null. As if it had never existed. When I say that colonial laws do not bind me, I am not being utopian. I am saying what the law itself secretly admits: when the foundation is rotten, the roof collapses. The language of law knows that it can annul itself. It knows. It hides it. And it continues to speak as if the roof held —

In 1886, *Norton v. Shelby County* (118 U.S. 425) wrote: "An unconstitutional act is not a law." A law that violates the constitution is not a law. It is wind. And wind cannot oblige. Wind may blow hard. It may make the branches tremble. But it cannot cut the roots. The roots are beneath the earth. The roots are in silence. The roots are in memory. And memory does not recognize —

In 1958, *Cooper v. Aaron* (358 U.S. 1) recalled that every judge swears an oath to the Constitution. Not to the government. Not to the State. To the Constitution. When a judge applies a law that overreaches, he breaks his oath. He no longer acts as a judge. He acts as an individual. *Scheuer v. Rhodes* (416 U.S. 232, 1974) confirms this: when a judge steps outside his jurisdiction, he is no longer protected. He becomes an ordinary man again, responsible for his —

In 1878, *United States v. Throckmorton* (98 U.S. 61) established that officials and judges are deemed to know the law and have sworn to uphold it. They cannot claim to act in good faith by wilfully depriving the law. They cannot plead ignorance. When I say that the grimoire is a lie, I do not say that judges cannot read. I say that they read knowingly. They know that the veil is torn. And they continue to —

In 1943, *Murdock v. Pennsylvania* (319 U.S. 105) struck down a license tax required to preach. The Court said that requiring permission to exercise what is fundamental is to transform it into a privilege. And a privilege can be withdrawn. When I refuse to ask permission to exist, I do nothing but claim — no, I live — what the law has already recognized: a freedom is not a commodity that one —

In 1969, *Shuttlesworth v. Birmingham* (373 U.S. 262) went further: if the State converts a freedom into a privilege, the citizen may ignore it. The word is there. Ignore. When I withdraw my consent, I invent nothing.

I exercise an option that the law itself has left —

So when I refuse to obey, I am not refusing justice. I am refusing imposture. The law itself, in its moments of lucidity, draws the limits of its own validity. It knows that it is a grimoire. It knows that it is a —

veil. It knows that behind the robes, there are only men. And men, they can err. They can lie. They can steal. They can kill. And when they do so under cover of law, it is no longer law. It is crime dressed in —

But beware: these judgments speak of their constitutions, their laws. I speak of the earth. I do not claim their rights. I observe that even within their own rules, their house is cracked. I do not need their permission to see the crack. I see it. That is enough. The veil is torn. And through the tear, one sees the —

Nabek — Off the Ship — Island of the Turtle — Year 410 of the 1616 Treaty

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